

Days to ultimate high or low. Patterns in bull markets with upward breakouts took more than four times as long as the other combinations to reach the ultimate high.

I compared the rise (upward breakouts) in bull and bear markets. I found that the bear market rise of 20% in 46 days was 2.7 times as fast as the 31% bull market rise in 196 days. Downward breakouts showed that the bear market drop was 2.2 times as fast as the bull market drop. In other words, price velocity is substantially higher in bear markets, regardless of the up or down direction.

How many change trend? I counted how many patterns saw price rise more than 20% after the breakout. For upward breakouts, I like to see values above 50%. Neither of the first two columns in the table comes close. Of course, we know that islands don't perform well, and this is more proof.

For downward breakouts, I don't have a benchmark in mind, but 48% is a good value.

Let's talk about failure rates next, in [Table 45.3](#), starting with an example. In bull markets after upward breakouts from island bottoms, I found that 31% of the chart patterns failed to see price rise more than 5%. Nearly half, 46%, failed to rise more than 10%. No offense, but that's awful.